

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A J 7

♥ 6 4 2

♦ 10 9 8 5

♣ 9 7 3

♠ Q 4 3

♥ J 7

♦ K J 4 3

♣ K Q J 5



♠ 10 8 6 5

♥ A K 3

♦ Q 7 2

♣ 8 4 2

♠ K 9 2

♥ Q 10 9 8 5

♦ A 6

♣ A 10 6

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠ 5

able to cash his last ♠.

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠ 5, dummy played the ♠ 2

Play the ♠ 7.

Partner's low ♠ lead tells you he has an honor in the suit, so it must be either the ♠ Q or the ♠ 10. North's jump to 2NT makes it almost certain that he holds the ♠ Q, so you can figure partner probably led from ♠ 10 x x 5.

Apply the Rule of 11. 11 minus 5 = 6 cards higher than the ♠ 5 held by dummy, you, and declarer. Since you can see 5 of the 6 you conclude that that declarer will have to play his ♠ Q to beat your ♠ 7.

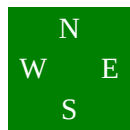
North will take the ♠ Q at trick 1, but when East wins a high ♥ he will play another ♠ through dummy's ♠ K 9 to your ♠ A J. Once you clear dummy's ♠ away partner will win another ♥ and be

Note that if dummy's ♠ 9 was played you would cover with your ♠ J, leading to the same situation.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ J 6 4
♥ 9 8
♦ A 5
♣ A J 10 7 4 2

♠ 9 7 3
♥ A Q 7
♦ J 10 8 7 3
♣ K 6



♠ A Q 10
♥ K 4 3
♦ K Q 9 2
♣ Q 8 5

♠ K 8 5 2
♥ J 10 6 5 2
♦ 6 4
♣ 9 3

West	North	East	South
		1NT	Pass

3NT
All Pass
3NT by East
Lead: ♥5

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥5, dummy played the ♥8

Play the ♥Q.

The Rule of Eleven tells you there are 6 cards in West, North and East that are higher than the ♥5. You can see 5 of them, so that leaves just one of them for East.

South cannot have all three of the outstanding honors, because from ♥K J 10 x x his correct lead would be the Jack. So you can deduce that East must hold exactly one of ♥K, ♥J, or ♥10.

If his honor is not the ♥K then it won't matter whether you play ♥A or ♥Q to the first trick; you will win your two top cards and then play your small one back to South.

So assume East actually holds the ♥K x x. If you play the ♥A to trick one, then lead ♥Q, East will hold up on the second trick, and win the third ♥. Then, when you win your ♣K you will not have a ♥ to return to partner and declarer will make the contract.

So what happens if you play the ♥Q at trick one? East could still make the contract by holding up, **but he will be afraid to do so**. After all, from his perspective it looks like South probably holds the ♥A and he will be afraid of losing the first 5 ♥ tricks, perhaps even when the ♣K finessing is working!

Board 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ K 5
♥ Q J 9 7 2
♦ A Q 6
♣ 9 7 3

♠ A J 8 3
♥ 10 6
♦ 7 5 2
♣ A K Q 5



♠ 7 4
♥ A K 4
♦ 10 9 8 4
♣ 10 8 4 2

♠ Q 10 9 6 2
♥ 8 5 3
♦ K J 3
♣ J 6

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠
2 ♥	3 ♠		
All Pass			
3 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥Q			

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥Q, dummy played the ♥6

Overtake with the ♥K.

Your side needs to take 5 tricks to defeat this contract. Two of them will be ♥s, but it doesn't look like you can win any ♣s or ♠s.

That means you need to win 3 ♦ tricks and the only way that can happen is if you play ♦s from your side.

So win the first ♥K (so partner will know you also have the ♥A), and play the ♦10. Presumably South will play an honor, but West will take the trick and put you back on lead with your ♥A. You play the ♦9 and your side will collect 3 ♦ tricks to go with your 2 ♥s.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 7 5 2
 ♥ A 10 9 5 4
 ♦ J
 ♣ K 10 8

♠ A K Q 8 6 4

♥ 8

♦ 7 4 2

♣ A J 9



♠ J 3

♥ K Q J 6

♦ A K Q 10 5

♣ 6 2

♠ 10

♥ 7 3 2

♦ 9 8 6 3

♣ Q 7 5 4 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

1 ♠

1 ♦

Pass

All Pass

4 ♥ by West

Lead: ♠ A

through West's ♣ K at trick 3.

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠ A, then the ♠ K. Dummy follows suit and it is your play to the second trick.

Ruff partner's ♠ K.

It is obvious that your side can only get 2 ♠ tricks. And assuming that West has the Ace of trumps you will not make a single trick in the red suits. So you need to make 2 ♣ tricks.

If partner has the ♣ A K then he will take them, but if he has the ♣ A J he cannot win 2 ♣ tricks from his side.

To allow for this situation it will be better to play ♣s from your side of the table, and the way to make that happen is for you to ruff partner's ♠ K with an otherwise useless trump. You still get your two ♠ winners (sort of) but now you get to play a ♣